

view of all your network connected devices, but internally it was no major improvement over XP and file transfer speeds were even lesser than XP generally. No amount of user-friendliness can mask the difference in speed. Windows 7 takes Vista's plethora of features and adds HomeGroups. But that's not it; the performance difference is noticeable. Transferring large files is significantly faster than even XP. The option of setting up a HomeGroup, which although limited with other Windows 7 machines, make networking simpler and managing a home server easier. Troubleshooting solves most basic problems without requiring any input from your part and you don't have to call tech support over minor problems like IP conflict and a disabled DHCP.

1.2.4 Security

There are plenty of reasons to like Windows XP, but security isn't one of them. Microsoft still releases patches and security updates for XP and will continue to do it till April 2014, but it still lacks internal security developments present in Vista and enhanced in Windows 7.

Agreed, Windows Vista's UAC is annoying and bugs you with too many notifications, but it ensures that your system is not meddled by third-party software applications. The utility is improved in Windows 7 and allows you to customise it with multiple security levels and choice of getting alerts or disabling them completely.

Windows 7 also comes with BitLocker, an encryption tool which was not there in any previous version of Windows. Unfortunately, this feature only comes with Ultimate edition of Windows, and other editions of Windows 7 and Vista users will be in the same position as XP.

In Windows 7 and Vista, system services are more isolated and run with fewer privileges, reducing the damage that malicious code can do. A new TCP/IP stack offers improved encryption and authentication options, and Address Space Layout Randomization loads system files as random memory addresses, making it far harder for basic malware to exploit key system functions.

Windows 7 borrows Vista's advances and allows you to customise so it scores above XP and Vista.

Its Windows 7 > Vista > XP in terms of Security.

1.2.5 Gaming

One of Windows USP is its gaming abilities. Even though Vista came out